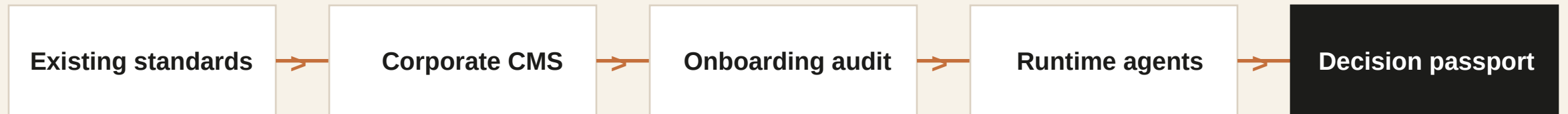


The Missing Infrastructure for Finance Agents

An incremental decision-control layer from existing standards to governed execution

EXECUTIVE QUESTION

Can we prove which approved policy, evidence, calculation, role, review and authorization allowed a material finance or procurement decision?



Existing standards describe business objects. The missing layer governs the decision.

Why leaders should care now

AI is reaching core workflows before the decision-control layer is mature.

AGENTS MOVE FROM ANSWERS TO ACTIONS

- classify invoices and journals
- recommend sourcing or supplier exceptions
- select policy treatments and calculations
- trigger workflow or ERP proposals

THE RISK IS UNPROVABLE AUTHORITY

**Why was the agent allowed
to make that decision,
using that policy, on that
evidence?**

EXECUTIVE VALUE

- controlled scale
- effective-dated policy execution
- human escalation for missing authority
- replayable evidence for audit
- population analysis after policy change

Most of the infrastructure already exists

The article is not claiming a blank-sheet standard. It identifies the missing governance bridge.

Structured standards

- IFRS / XBRL
- XBRL GL
- ISO 21378
- ISO/TS 21377

Enterprise systems

- ERP / P2P
- tax / treasury
- planning / workflow
- audit logs

Knowledge stores

- policy CMS
- procedures
- approved facts
- rules packages

Execution interfaces

- APIs / MCP
- RAG / search
- workflow engines
- identity services

MISSING BLOCK: GOVERNED DECISION SEMANTICS

Approved knowledge + role authority + deterministic logic + review + escalation + provenance

Before runtime: onboarding agents audit the enterprise

The first agent task is discovery, not posting.

Policy discovery	ERP landscape	Process mapping	Control audit	Architecture challenge
owners, versions, effective dates	objects, interfaces, permissions	variants, handoffs, workarounds	SoD, thresholds, evidence	PRD, ADRs, gaps, escalation

GOVERNED OUTPUTS
readiness audit - PRD - ADRs - control matrix - data contracts role contracts - decision passport - implementation backlog explicit CFO / CPO / CIO / Risk approvals

Runtime agents: bounded lanes and human escalation

The model is a controlled operating process, not a general bot.

Accounting

classify and prepare

Tax

validate treatment

Treasury

payment and liquidity

Procurement

supplier / PO / award

Controller

materiality and period

Audit

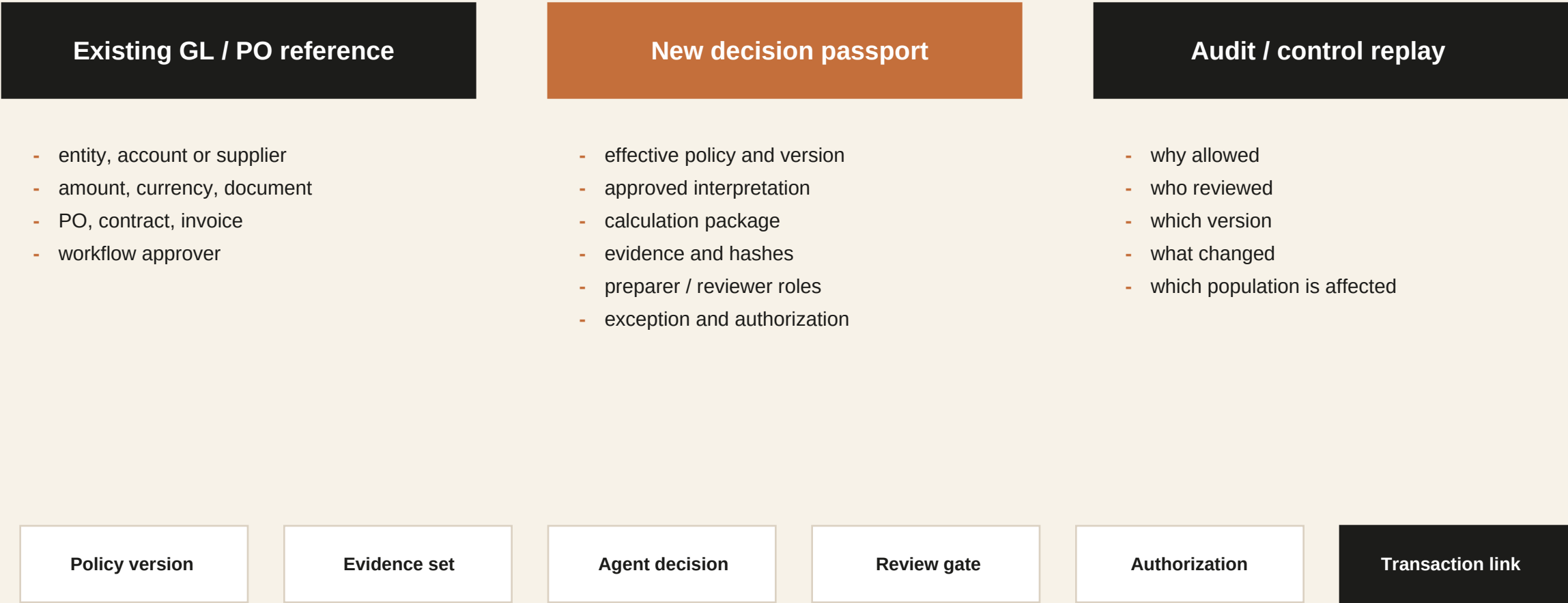
replay and policy trail

ESCALATION RULE

Missing authority, conflicting policy, unsupported evidence, model disagreement, threshold breach or material judgment -> human owner.

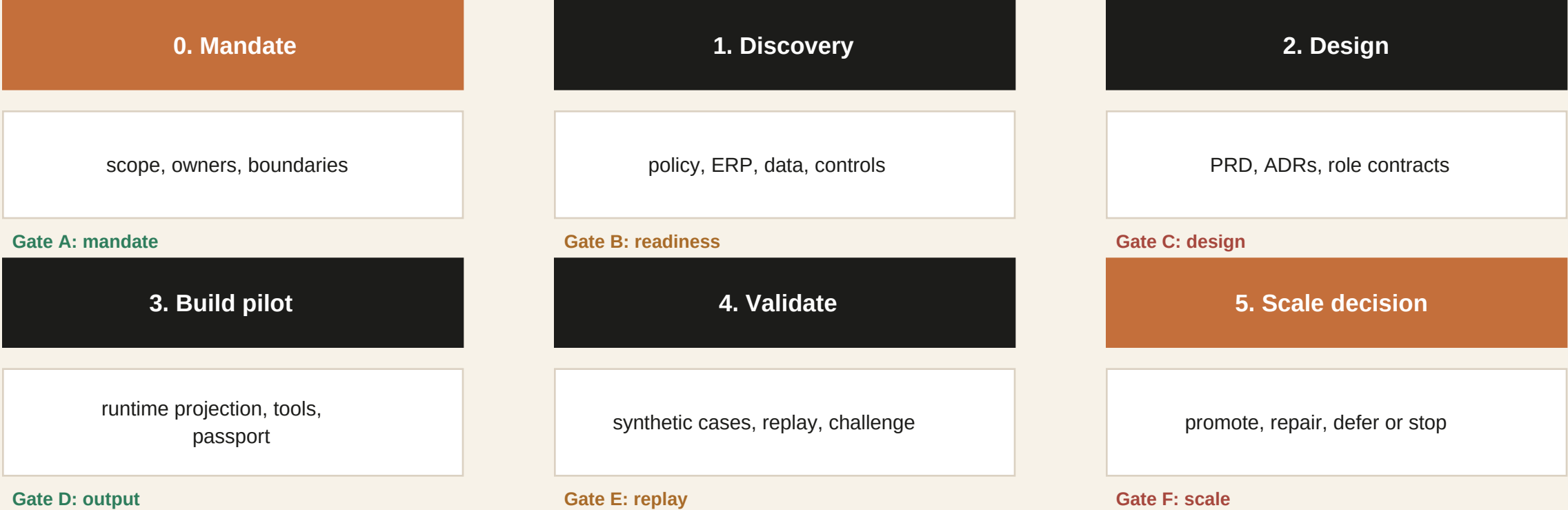
Decision passport: the metadata layer beside GL and PO

The business record keeps the transaction; the passport keeps the decision trail.



Illustrative project plan

A bounded proof of method before production execution.



No runtime agent receives executable authority until the design package is approved.

OKR mapping and executive takeaway

Measure decision quality and replayability, not tool novelty.

OBJECTIVE

Establish a governed agent-readiness pattern that connects approved knowledge, role-bounded execution and decision replay for one workflow.

KR1 - Readiness

in-scope policies, systems, roles and evidence paths classified

KR3 - Replay

controller or auditor can reproduce pilot decisions

KR2 - Control

material decisions require approved policy, deterministic logic or escalation

KR4 - Scale

owner returns promote, repair, defer or stop with evidence

**START SMALL. PROVE REPLAYABILITY.
SCALE ONLY AFTER EVIDENCE GATES PASS.**